

CRANK Stakeholder Onboarding Guide

Your job in KICK is to steer, not to receive a status update.

THE ROLE IN ONE SENTENCE

Stakeholders are external to the build team and attend the Stakeholder KICK only. Mid-cycle requirements you introduce are not disruptions -- they are expected inputs that the Intake Coordinator and CRANK Lead capture and navigate. Your primary job in the room is to make real decisions, not to nod through a status update.

WHAT CRANK ASKS OF YOU THAT SCRUM DID NOT

In a traditional sprint review, your presence was closer to optional and your role was closer to audience. In CRANK, the Stakeholder KICK does not function without you -- or without someone you've delegated real decision authority to. If a KICK produces zero committed decisions because the person in the room can't actually decide, that's a named process failure the CRANK Lead will escalate, not a quiet inconvenience.

If you cannot attend a given Stakeholder KICK, send someone with real decision authority -- not just someone who can take notes and report back.

WHERE YOU SHOW UP IN THE FLYWHEEL

Phase	Your role
Charge	Informed -- you may originate a signal, but capture and triage happen without you in the room.
Run / Assess	Not involved -- this is internal build work.
Navigate	Consulted -- the CRANK Lead may check with you on direction that affects your priorities.
Stakeholder KICK	Responsible -- this is your meeting. Steer, review velocity, and make real calls.
Steering document	Informed -- you can see what was decided and why, without owning the upkeep.

WHAT A GOOD STAKEHOLDER KICK LOOKS LIKE FROM YOUR SIDE

- Live demo, only when there is something new to show -- you are not owed a demo every session.
- Steer: you confirm current priorities still hold, or you redirect them, on the spot.
- Velocity: the CRANK Lead shares real numbers -- cycle time, ship rate, blockers -- not a narrative summary designed to reassure you.
- Escalation Path: if you can't personally commit to something in the room, that gets flagged immediately --

not discovered after the meeting ends.

- Q&A + Team Review: misalignment between what you asked for and what the team built gets surfaced here, not left to fester.

INTRODUCING A MID-CYCLE REQUIREMENT

Bring it to the Intake Coordinator, or raise it in the Steer block of Stakeholder KICK. It gets captured raw -- not filtered or reinterpreted -- and routed to the CRANK Lead, who triages it within 30 minutes: actionable now, next cycle, or navigated around the current work. You will get a real answer either way. "Never Say No" does not mean everything gets built immediately -- some requests get a better solution, a few hit a real limitation, but none get silence.

COMMON STAKEHOLDER MISTAKES

- Sending a proxy without real decision authority -- this is the single most common cause of a stalled Stakeholder KICK.
- Treating the Steer block as a status update you passively receive, rather than a moment to actually redirect priorities.
- Routing a new requirement directly to a Developer instead of through the Intake Coordinator -- this creates an unmanaged, unlogged blocker.
- Expecting a live demo every session -- it only happens when there's something new to show.
- Going dark between KICKs -- if you're unreachable for a genuine decision, name a backup before it becomes a problem.

SUCCESS INDICATORS

- Stakeholder KICK regularly produces at least one committed decision, not just a review.
- You can name the current cycle's priority without checking your email first.
- New requirements you raise get a real triage answer within 30 minutes, not silence.
- You've never been surprised by what the team built, because misalignment got caught in Q&A + Team Review before it shipped.